

Homework 1: One-Year Stock Comparison

PLTR (Palantir) compared with SPY | Prepared for QI Academy

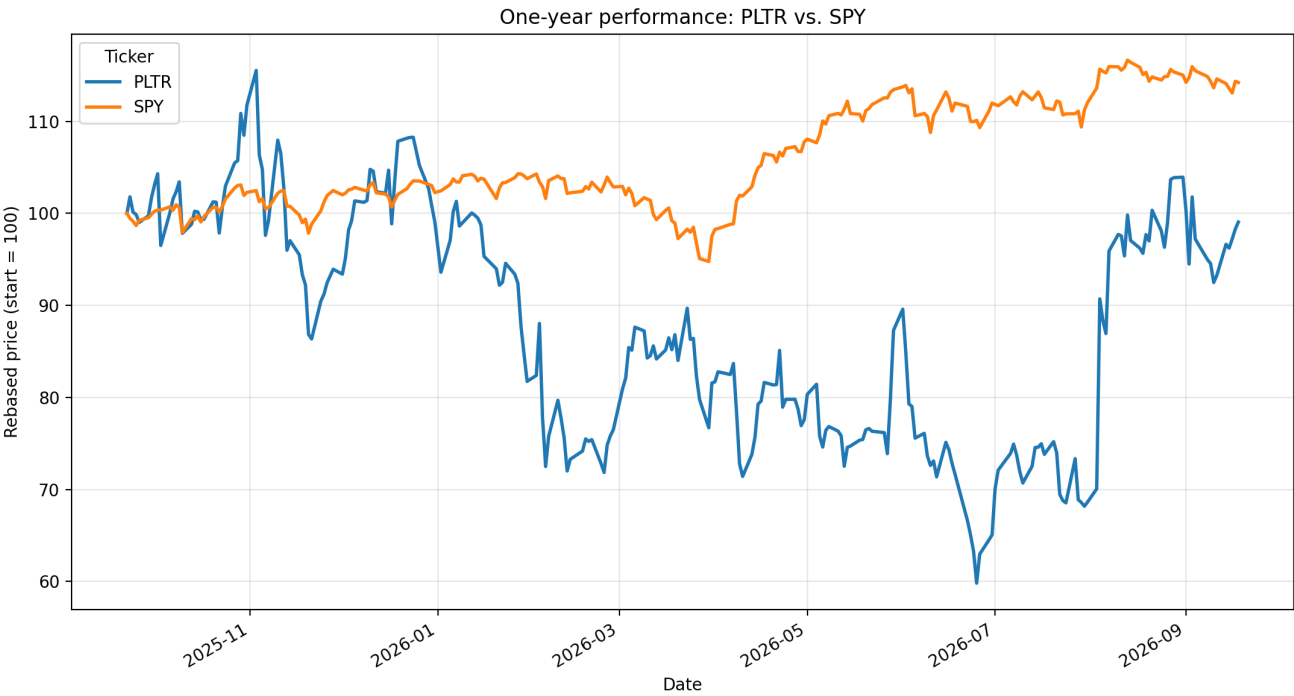
Repository: github.com/evilaechik/algory-qi-f26

Data summary

Ticker	Last close	One-year return	Annualised volatility
PLTR	\$177.64	-0.94%	60.78%
SPY	\$761.69	14.22%	12.95%

The sample contains 250 shared trading days, from September 22, 2025 through September 18, 2026. Prices are raw daily closes; rows missing either ticker were removed before calculating returns.

Rebased performance chart



Both lines start at exactly 100, so the chart compares percentage performance rather than the price level of each share.

Largest single-day move

August 4, 2026: PLTR rose 29.45%. Palantir reported exceptionally strong second-quarter results, including 93% year-over-year revenue growth and 149% growth in U.S. commercial revenue. Investors also reacted to management's largest-ever guidance increase, a signal that demand for the company's AI software was accelerating.

Source: [Palantir Q2 2026 earnings release \(SEC filing\)](#).

What the chart shows

PLTR returned -0.94% over the year while SPY returned 14.22%, so Palantir lagged the broad market. PLTR was also much more volatile: its annualised volatility was 60.78%, versus 12.95% for SPY. I would be cautious about holding PLTR because its growth story is compelling, but the much rougher trading path and weaker one-year result make it riskier than the broad market.

Career research: Summer 2027 applications

Firm	Relevant internship	Applications opened
IMC Trading	Quantitative Research Intern	June 28, 2026
Optiver	Quantitative Intern	July 2, 2026
Two Sigma	Quantitative Researcher Intern	June 28, 2026

The dates above were checked on September 20, 2026 against current internship listings. Quant recruiting is rolling, so applying early matters. Current career pages: [Two Sigma](#), [Optiver](#), and [IMC Trading](#).

LinkedIn profile

Artem Lavrentyev - Emory University
Bachelor's Degree, Data Science | August 2026 - May 2030
[linkedin.com/in/artem-lavrentyev-b93870282](https://www.linkedin.com/in/artem-lavrentyev-b93870282)

Education details are included in the profile. Keep a clear real profile photo visible.

Method: daily percentage returns are calculated with `pct_change()`; annualised volatility is the standard deviation of daily returns multiplied by $\sqrt{252}$.